

Subject: Political Science Rubric

GradeC +

VerdictAverage performance showing historical knowledge but needing deeper analysis.

Max Marks20

Detected Question

Compare the political and constitutional crises faced by Pakistan between 1947 and 1956 and the post-2008 era. How do they reflect structural weaknesses in governance?

Breakdown of the Question

This question requires a comparative analysis of crises in two distinct periods of Pakistan's history, focusing on political instability, constitutional challenges, and their implications for governance structures. A top-tier answer must identify key crises, contrast them across eras, and link them to enduring institutional weaknesses like power imbalances and lack of continuity.

1. Identification of Crises in 1947-1956

- Leadership vacuum post-independence (e.g., Jinnah's death, Liaquat's assassination).
- Constitutional delays (e.g., reliance on 1935 India Act).
- Arbitrary executive actions (e.g., Governor-General Ghulam Muhammad's dissolution).
- Ethnic disunity from forced mergers (e.g., Balochistan, Sindh).
- Judiciary validating undemocratic moves (e.g., Tamizuddin Case).

2. Identification of Crises in Post-2008

- Civil-military tensions behind democratic facade (e.g., Memogate scandal).
- Judicial overreach into politics (e.g., Nawaz Sharif disqualification in Panama case).
- Weak and divided coalitions (e.g., PDM alliance 2022).
- Undermined rule of law and accountability (e.g., NAB targeting opposition).
- Constitutional conflicts between judiciary and executive (e.g., 2023 Punjab/KP election delays).

3. Comparative Analysis

- Highlight similarities (e.g., recurring executive-judiciary clashes) and differences (e.g., early era's foundational instability vs. post-2008 hybrid regime struggles).
- Apply to modern contexts like Pakistan's evolution toward hybrid democracy.

4. Reflection on Structural Weaknesses

- Link crises to broader issues like institutional discontinuity, absence of checks/balances, military influence, and weak local governance.
- Use theoretical frameworks (e.g., referencing state-building theories or Islamic political concepts like Shura for governance).

Key requirements for high distinction:

- Direct comparison of crises across eras with evidence from history.
- Critical evaluation of how they expose governance flaws, supported by thinkers or cases.
- Balanced structure with intro, body (eras and comparisons), conclusion.
- Integration of political theory (e.g., sovereignty, legitimacy) and references to Pakistan's systems.

Evaluation of the Submitted Answer

1. Understanding of Question and Relevance – 3/4

Strengths

- Accurately identifies key crises in both periods, directly addressing comparison and reflection on weaknesses (e.g., 'A State Without a Stable Political Compass' for 1947-1956).
- Uses subheadings tied to question components like leadership vacuum and judicial overreach.

Weaknesses

- Minor digressions into specific cases without full integration of all question parts.
- Lacks explicit addressing of 'constitutional crises' depth in post-2008 section.

Verdict: Good grasp with relevant structure, but could better balance all elements.

2. Conceptual Clarity and Theoretical Depth – 2.5/5

Strengths

- References key historical concepts and events (e.g., 1935 Government of India Act, Tamizuddin Case, Panama Papers).
- Cites sources like M.R. Kazmi, Ayesha Jalal, Husain Haqqani for factual grounding.

Weaknesses

- Lacks definitions or distinctions of core concepts (e.g., no discussion of sovereignty or legitimacy in crises).
- Minimal integration of political thinkers (e.g., no Locke or Iqbal references) or Islamic concepts like Khilafah.

Verdict: Basic awareness of historical facts, but superficial without theoretical depth.

Evaluation of the Submitted Answer

3. Critical Analysis and Argumentation – 2/4

Strengths

- Offers some evaluation, e.g., 'exposed civilian fear of a military coup' in Memogate, linking to power struggles.
- Presents logical progression from crises to weaknesses.

Weaknesses

- Predominantly descriptive outline; limited independent judgment or critique (e.g., no strengths/weaknesses of institutional responses).
- No balanced representation of opposing views on crises' impacts.

Verdict: Limited critical reasoning, mostly factual listing.

4. Comparative Insight and Application – 1.5/2

Strengths

- Directly contrasts eras via parallel subheadings (e.g., arbitrary authority in 1953 vs. judicial overreach in 2017).
- Applies to Pakistan's context, e.g., recurring military influence.

Weaknesses

- Comparisons are implicit in structure but not explicitly analyzed (e.g., no cross-era insights on evolution).
- Minimal real-world application beyond Pakistan (e.g., no links to global hybrid regimes).

Verdict: Partial comparative insight through organization, but lacks depth.

Evaluation of the Submitted Answer

5. Structure, Organization, and Coherence – 2.5/3

Strengths

- Clear outline format with intro, era-specific sections, broader weaknesses, and planned critical appraisal/conclusion.
- Logical flow from specific crises to structural reflections; balanced coverage.

Weaknesses

- Incomplete development (e.g., no full prose in body or conclusion).
- Some unevenness in subtopic depth, with post-2008 less detailed.

Verdict: Structured and coherent outline, but lacks full essay cohesion.

6. Language, Expression, and Scholarly Tone – 1/2

Strengths

- Formal tone with political terms like 'judicial overreach' and 'constitutional conflict'.
- Neutral and analytical phrasing in examples.

Weaknesses

- Numerous spelling/grammar errors (e.g., 'suddesters' for successors, 'disqualified' misspelled).
- Handwriting affects readability; some sentences fragmented.

Verdict: Understandable but unrefined due to errors.

Total Score & Verdict

Grade: C +

Verdict: Average performance showing historical knowledge but needing deeper analysis.

The response effectively outlines crises and links them to governance weaknesses, demonstrating relevance to Pakistan's political evolution. However, it falls short in theoretical depth and critical engagement, resulting in a descriptive rather than analytical submission. Strengthening comparisons and reducing language errors would elevate it to a higher grade.

The response demonstrates solid understanding of historical crises and uses structured outlines with relevant examples and references, but remains largely descriptive without deep theoretical integration, critical evaluation, or balanced comparison between eras. Language issues and incomplete development limit higher scoring.

Actionable Recommendations

- Develop full paragraphs from outline for deeper analysis and critical engagement.
- Incorporate political theory (e.g., social contract theory) to explain crises' roots.
- Proofread for spelling and grammar to enhance scholarly tone.
- Expand comparisons with quantitative data (e.g., number of dissolutions) and global parallels (e.g., Turkey's hybrid system).

High-Scoring Ideal Outline

Question: Compare the political and constitutional crises faced by Pakistan between 1947 and 1956 and the post-2008 era. How do they reflect structural weaknesses in governance?

Introduction

- Define key terms: political crises (e.g., leadership vacuums, ethnic tensions), constitutional crises (e.g., delays, dissolutions).
- Outline structure: crises in each era, comparisons, reflections on weaknesses.
- Thesis: Both eras reveal enduring flaws in state-building, echoing theories like Hobbes' Leviathan for authority instability.

Crises in 1947-1956: Foundational Instability

- Leadership vacuum: Jinnah/Liaquat deaths leading to unstable PMs (Kazmi reference).
- Constitutional delay: 9-year reliance on 1935 Act, undermining sovereignty.
- Arbitrary executive: Ghulam Muhammad's 1953 dissolution despite assembly majority (Lawrence Ziring).
- Ethnic disunity: Forced mergers igniting resentment (Ayesha Jalal).
- Judiciary's role: Tamizuddin Case (1955) validating undemocratic rule (PLD 1955).

Crises in Post-2008: Hybrid Regime Struggles

- Civil-military conflict: Memogate (2011) exposing coup fears (Haqqani's Magnificent Delusions).
- Judicial overreach: Nawaz Sharif's 2017 disqualification on minor issue (PLD 2017 SC 692).
- Weak coalitions: PDM (2022) internal contradictions obstructing reforms.
- Undermined accountability: NAB's disproportionate targeting (HRCP 2020 report).
- Executive-judiciary clashes: 2023 Punjab/KP delays via Article 224 interpretation.

Comparative Analysis

- Similarities: Recurring unelected influence (military/executive in early vs. judiciary post-2008).
- Differences: Early era's absolutism vs. post-2008 legalistic interventions.
- Application: Links to Pakistan's federalism challenges, comparable to India's post-1947 consolidation.

Aspect	1947-1956	Post-2008	Implication
Power Concentration	Governor-General dominance	Judicial activism	Erodes democratic legitimacy
Institutional Role	Judiciary enables dissolution	Judiciary dissolves assemblies	Weakens checks and balances
External Influence	Ethnic mergers	Military shadows	Undermines federal unity

Reflection on Structural Weaknesses

- Lack of continuity: 14 PM changes 1947-2025 erode sustainability.
- Absence of checks: Ordinance overuse from Ghulam Muhammad to Imran Khan.
- Overdependence on unelected: Military influence in decisions (e.g., ISR press conferences).
- Weak local governance: Punjab elections ignored 2016-2022 despite provisions.

Critical Appraisal and Conclusion

- Evaluate: Crises reflect hybrid system's flaws; recommend Shura-inspired reforms for inclusivity.
- Conclude: Addressing weaknesses requires institutional reforms for stable governance.

Question # 01

Compare the political and constitutional crises faced by Pakistan between 1947 and 1956 and the post-2008 era. How do they reflect structural weaknesses in governance?

Outline(1) Introduction(a) 1947- 1956 : A State Without a Stable Political Compassa) Leadership Vacuum post Independence

Ex: After Quaid-e-Azam death (1948), Liaqat Ali Khan's assassination left

Pakistan leaderless, with four

Prime Ministers in just four years.

(M.R. Kazmi; A Concise History of Pak)

b) Constitutional Delay and Institutional paralysis

Ex: Pakistan operated without a permanent constitution for 9 years, relying on the 1935 Government of India Act.

Writing Issues – Page 1spelling

Page 1 – leadership vacuum example

Original: suddesters

Correction: successors

Rewrite: Pakistan's successors with four Prime Ministers in four years.

Why: Misspelling of 'successors' due to handwriting; affects clarity of historical reference.

spelling

Page 1 – post-independence example

Original: minister

Correction: ministers

Rewrite: Prime Ministers in less than four years.

Why: Typo in 'ministers' (should be capitalized as proper noun); minor but repetitive error.

grammar

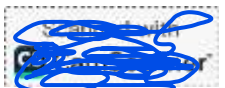
Page 1 – constitutional delay section

Original: Ex: Pakistan operated without a permanent constitution for 9 years, relying on the 1935 Government of India Act.

Correction: Ex: Pakistan operated without a permanent constitution for 9 years, relying on the 1935 Government of India Act.

Rewrite: For example, Pakistan operated without a permanent constitution for nine years, relying on the 1935 Government of India Act.

Why: Fragmented sentence structure; needs full expansion for coherence.



(Constitutional and Political History of Pakistan, Hamid Khan)

Writing Issues - Page 2

spelling

Page 2 - heading c

Original: Arbitrary Executive Authority Undermined Parliamentment

Correction: Arbitrary Executive Authority Undermined Parliament

Rewrite: Arbitrary executive authority undermined parliament.

Why: Misspelling of 'Parliament' and awkward phrasing impacts scholarly tone.

c) Arbitrary Executive Authority Undermined Parliament

Ex: Governor General Ghulam

Muhammad dismissed PM Noximuddi

in 1953 despite majority support in

the Assembly.

(Lawrence Ziring: Pakistan in the

Twentieth Century)

spelling

Page 2 - executive authority example

Original: dissolved PM Noximuddi

Correction: dissolved PM

Nazimuddin

Rewrite: Governor-General Ghulam Muhammad dismissed PM Nazimuddin in 1953

Why: Incorrect name 'Noximuddi' for Nazimuddin; factual error in transcription.

spelling

Page 2 - heading d

Original: Ethnic disunity due to fuced provincial Mergers

Correction: Ethnic disunity due to forced provincial mergers

Rewrite: Ethnic disunity due to forced provincial mergers.

Why: 'Fuced' misspelled as 'forced'; common handwriting error.

d) Ethnic disunity due to forced provincial Mergers

Ex: The imposition of one Unit scheme

merged West Pakistan's provinces,

igniting ethnic resentment in

Balochistan and Sindh.

(Ayesha Jalal; The Struggle for Pakistan)

e) Judiciary Enabled Undemocratic Rule

Ex: In the ^{Khan} Tarniuddin Case (1955),

the court validated the dissolution

of the Constituent Assembly



by an unelected Government
(PLD 1955 Federal Court 240)

Writing Issues - Page 3

spelling

Page 3 - post-2008 heading

Original: Captured by Power Struggles and legal Battels

Correction: Captured by Power Struggle and Legal Battles

Rewrite: A democracy captured by power struggles and legal battles.

Why: 'Battels' to 'battles'; minor spelling issue

(3) Post 2008 : A Democracy Captured by Power Struggles and Legal Battles

spelling

Page 3 - civil-military conflict example

Original: Memogate Scandal(2011)

Correction: Memogate Scandal (2011)

Rewrite: The Memogate scandal (2011) exposed civilian fear.

Why: Spacing and capitalization inconsistency.

(i) Civil - Military conflict
democratic Facade

Ex: The Memogate Scandal (2011)
exposed civilian fear of military
coup after Osama Bin Laden's
killing.

grammar

Page 3 - judicial overreach example

Original: PM Nawaz Sharif was disqualified in 2017 over a minor iqama issue following the Panama leaks, a ruling widely seen as politically motivated.

Correction: PM Nawaz Sharif was disqualified in 2017 over a minor iqama issue following the Panama leaks, a ruling widely seen as politically motivated.

Rewrite: Prime Minister Nawaz Sharif was disqualified in 2017 over a minor iqama issue stemming from the Panama leaks, widely viewed as politically motivated (PLD 2017 SC 692).

(Husain Haqqani, Magnificent
Delusions)

(ii) Judicial Overreach into political
domain

Ex: PM Nawaz Sharif was
disqualified in 2017 over a minor
"iqama" issue following the Panama
leaks, a ruling widely seen as
a politically motivated.

Why: Run-on sentence; needs emphasis of restructuring for clarity.

(PLD 2017 SC 692)



(iii) Weak and divided Coalition Governments

Ex: The PDM alliance (2022) struggled with internal contradictions, obstructing consistent governance and reform.

Spelling

Page 4 – heading iii

Original: Weak and Divided Coalition Governments

Correction: Weak and Divided Coalition Governments

Rewrite: Weak and divided coalition governments.

Why: 'Divided' for 'divided'; spelling error.

Spelling

Page 4 – coalition example

Original: struggled with internal contradictions

Correction: struggled with internal contradictions

Rewrite: The PDM alliance (2022) struggled with internal contradictions.

Why: Misspellings of 'struggled' and 'contradictions' affects readability.

(iv) Politicized accountability undermines rule of law

Ex: The National Accountability Bureau (NAB) arrested opposition leaders disproportionately during PTI rule, drawing criticism from HRCIP and international bodies.

Spelling

Page 4 – accountability section

Original: disproportionately during PTI rule

Correction: disproportionately during PTI rule

Rewrite: NAB arrested opposition leaders disproportionately during PTI rule.

Why: 'Disproportionately' severely misspelled; undermines credibility.

(Human Rights Commission of Pakistan Report 2020)

v) Constitutional conflict between Judiciary and Executive

Ex: The 2023 deadlock over Punjab and KP elections showed the inability to enforce constitutional timelines due to political interference in Article 224 interpretation



(Supreme Court Order in suo moto
Case No. 1 of 2023)

(4) Broader structural weaknesses in Governance Across Both Eras

a) Lack of Institutional continuity

~~Ex:~~ Frequent weak parliamentary
roots and regime changes undermine
political sustainability

Ex: 14 prime ministers
been changed between 1947-2025

b) Absence of Checks and Balances

Ex: From Ghulam Muhammad to
Imran Khan, leaders used ordinances
excessively

c) Overdependence on Unelected
institutions

Ex: Military's ^{excessive} influence over civil
decision such as ISPR press conferences
influence political narratives.

d) Weak Local Government
system

Writing Issues - Page 5

spelling

Page 5 - heading 4

Original: Broader structural
Weakness in Governance Across
Both Eras

Correction: Broader Structural
Weaknesses in Governance Across
Both Eras

Rewrite: Broader structural
weaknesses in governance across
both eras.

Why: 'Weakness' should be plural;
minor agreement error.

spelling

Page 5 - lack of continuity example

Original: Frequent weak
parliamentary roots and regime
changes undermine

Correction: Frequent weak
parliamentary roots and regime
changes undermine

Rewrite: Frequent weak
parliamentary turns and regime
changes undermine political
sustainability

Why: 'Parliamentary' for
'parliamentary'; unclear phrasing.

grammar

Page 5 - checks and balances section

Original: From Ghulam Muhammad
to Imran Khan, leaders used
ordinances excessively

Correction: From Ghulam
Muhammad to Imran Khan, leaders
used ordinances excessively.

Rewrite: From Ghulam Muhammad
to Imran Khan, leaders have used
ordinances excessively.

Why: Fragment; needs verb tense
consistency and punctuation.



Grassroot democracy remains ignored
despite constitutional provisions such as
punjab local government elections
were not held from 2016 to 2022

Writing Issues – Page 6

spelling

Page 6 – local government point

Original: Grassroot democracy remains ignored

Correction: Grassroots democracy remains ignored

Rewrite: Grassroots democracy remains ignored despite constitutional provisions.

Why: 'Grassroot' and 'democracy' misspelled; plural and spelling errors.

spelling

Page 6 – grassroots democracy

Original: despite constitutional provisions such as

Correction: despite constitutional provisions such as

Rewrite: Despite constitutional provisions such as Punjab local government elections.

Why: 'Despiete' for 'despite'; basic spelling mistake.

5- Critical Appraisal
6- Conclusion